Westbrook School Committee

~ Finance Committee Meeting ~

Date: Tuesday, March 24, 2026
Time: 5:00 PM
Location: Westbrook High School (Room 114), 125 Stroudwater St. (Hybrid via Zoom)
Video: https://vimeo.com/1176707021
Packet: No agenda was published for this meeting (checked westbrookschools.org, 2026-10-24).

Timestamps below are clickable [0:00]-style links — they jump straight to that moment in the video.

This summary highlights the meeting's key discussions and decisions, with direct quotes and timestamps for verification — it is not a substitute for watching the full meeting. *The full committee sat as the committee of the whole for this third consecutive FY27 cost-center budget review session; no votes were taken. For complete context, nuance, and anything not covered, watch the full video at the link above. (Produced by: WestbrookCurrents.com)*

Unofficial summary. *This is produced by Westbrook Currents, an independent site — not the City of Westbrook — and may contain mistakes. For the official record, see the City's approved minutes and the meeting video.*

School Nutrition & Athletics

School Nutrition: Fully Self-Funded, New Education Coordinator [1:00]

Discussion Summary

Director Mary Emerson confirmed the program is fully funded by federal/state meal reimbursements and puts no local taxpayer dollars on the table. The budget proposes a new Nutrition Education Coordinator (~$64,046 net of expiring FoodCorps funding it partly replaces). The program recently won the Southern Maine school-nutrition cook-off, advancing to the state competition.

Key Decisions

✓ No vote — budget review.

Action Items

None.

Athletics & Activities: New Playoff/Officiating Costs, Software Review [13:01]

Discussion Summary

Director Mark Campbell (first budget cycle) reported 511 high school and 405 middle school athlete participations, plus 26 and 12 clubs respectively, and flagged a 15-point gender participation gap he is working to track more precisely. New costs include officiating fee increases (tied to CPI) and, for the first time, a budgeted line for playoff-game officiating/travel (five playoff games hosted this year already). A roughly $4,600 software savings was identified live during review by scaling back an athletic-management platform.

Key Decisions

✓ No vote — budget review.

Action Items

None.

Point / Counterpoint

> *“This $121,000 has not sat super comfortably with the committee...we want to understand what is the real need versus what is showing up in our budget books.”*

— Andrea Mancuso, School Committee Chair (on the city's $121,000 athletic-field maintenance charge) [32:02]

Westbrook Middle School

Budget Overview: Restored PD/Library Lines, ~$160K Utility Savings [40:14]

Discussion Summary

Principal Dr. Borsaw (new this year) presented a budget restoring previously zeroed-out professional development and library equipment lines, confirmed roughly $160,000 in combined utility savings at the school, and expects about 22 more students next year (mostly incoming fifth graders) with no new classroom staffing request.

Key Decisions

✓ No vote — budget review.

Action Items

None.

Point / Counterpoint

> *“For $30 a student, we can fix the bathrooms at the middle school and make children comfortable...We spend more money on athletic department software than it would take to fix an entire grade span's bathrooms that the kids are feeling so deeply about...I will have a hard time supporting this budget if we don't fix the bathroom issue at the middle school.”*

— Andrea Mancuso, School Committee Chair (on inadequate middle school bathroom privacy, a $23,000 fix not in the budget) [58:13]

> *“It's well documented that SROs do not contribute to the educational setting...coming from New York City, I was in a school that had security, metal detectors at every door...they moved it to a small school model, got rid of all the SROs...achievement went up, discipline went down.”*

— A newly-seated committee member (on School Resource Officer funding) [01:04:24]

Westbrook High School

A Multi-Year English Teacher Request, Compass Program Relocation [01:57:38]

Discussion Summary

Principal Jeff Garrett reported strong outcomes (38% of students in early college/AP/dual enrollment) and renewed the school's multi-year request for a new English teacher — seven teachers currently cover roughly 700 students, versus eight in math, with English the only subject required all four years and some sections approaching 25 students. Also proposed: continuing to relocate the school's Compass alternative-education program (about 15 students) from a separate outbuilding into renovated space inside the main building, and a technology shift from MacBooks toward iPads following a fall pilot. Both the high school's and middle school's SRO funding were added to the revisit list, alongside library equipment (previously zeroed out) and a roughly $4,600 IXL software correction identified live during review.

Key Decisions

✓ No vote — budget review.

Action Items

None.

WRVC & Adult Education

WRVC: Two New Programs, Enrollment Growth, Aging-Building Concerns [03:08:11]

Discussion Summary

Director Gloria Noyes reported enrollment up 44–50 students despite closing the CDL program, driven by active recruitment. The budget funds two new programs — a CTE Exploratory Program and a Cooperative Education internship program — both expected to further grow enrollment and state subsidy. Noyes flagged aging-building issues at the roughly 30-year-old facility (roof leaks, inconsistent temperatures, no secure entry vestibule) that the committee indicated may be addressed within the operating budget.

Key Decisions

✓ No vote — budget review.

Action Items

None.

Adult Education: Top-Performing Program, Nearly Self-Funded [04:09:44]

Discussion Summary

Director Jen Brooks reported the state's third-largest adult education program, recognized this year as a top performer in Maine, serving 576 students (up nearly 7%). The program is almost entirely self-funded through workforce-training revenue, grants, and a state subsidy up 9.88% to $165,122, leaving a local-share cost of roughly $376,310. The budget shifts toward expanded digital literacy instruction, partly in response to earlier-this-year instability tied to immigration-enforcement concerns affecting students' ability to attend in person.

Key Decisions

✓ No vote — budget review.

Action Items

None.

How this was made

This summary was produced from the meeting video (linked above, hosted on the City's Vimeo showcase). The audio was transcribed with AI-assisted speech-to-text and speaker identification. This process cross-checked names against the official School Committee roster, attributed speakers from context (introductions, roll-call order, direct address by the Chair) rather than the raw diarization labels alone, and drafted this summary and the quoted excerpts. Quotes are lightly cleaned of filler words/false starts but not reworded. Review tier: Not reviewed.

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